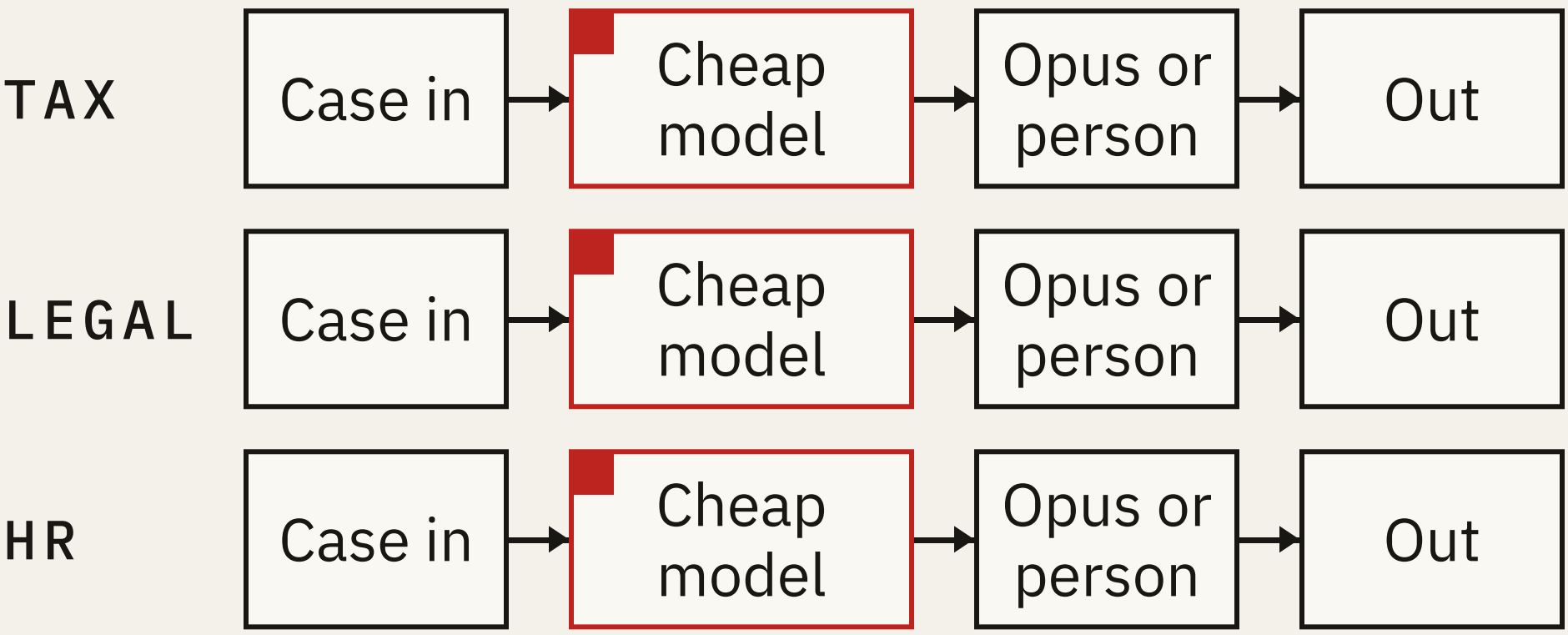
CHEAP-TIER-LEGAL-TAX-HR · 1,414 CASES

Where a 10-cent model goes in tax, legal, HR



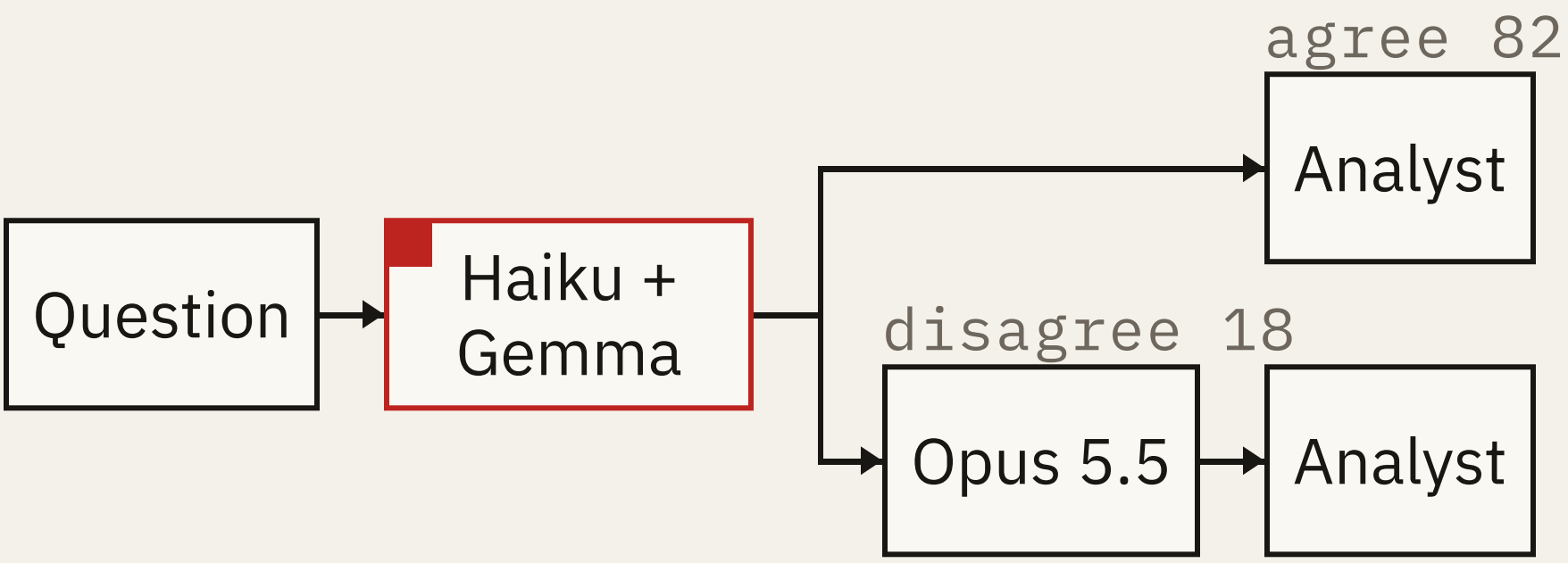
One of four can say when it is unsure.

Haiku 5.5, GPT-6 Luna, Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite, Gemma 4 on a laptop, against Opus 5.5. 10 tasks.

Short benchmark texts, not whole files. Experts labelling advice items disagreed about 1 time in 6.

TAX CONSULTING · 438 CASES

The first pass on a client question



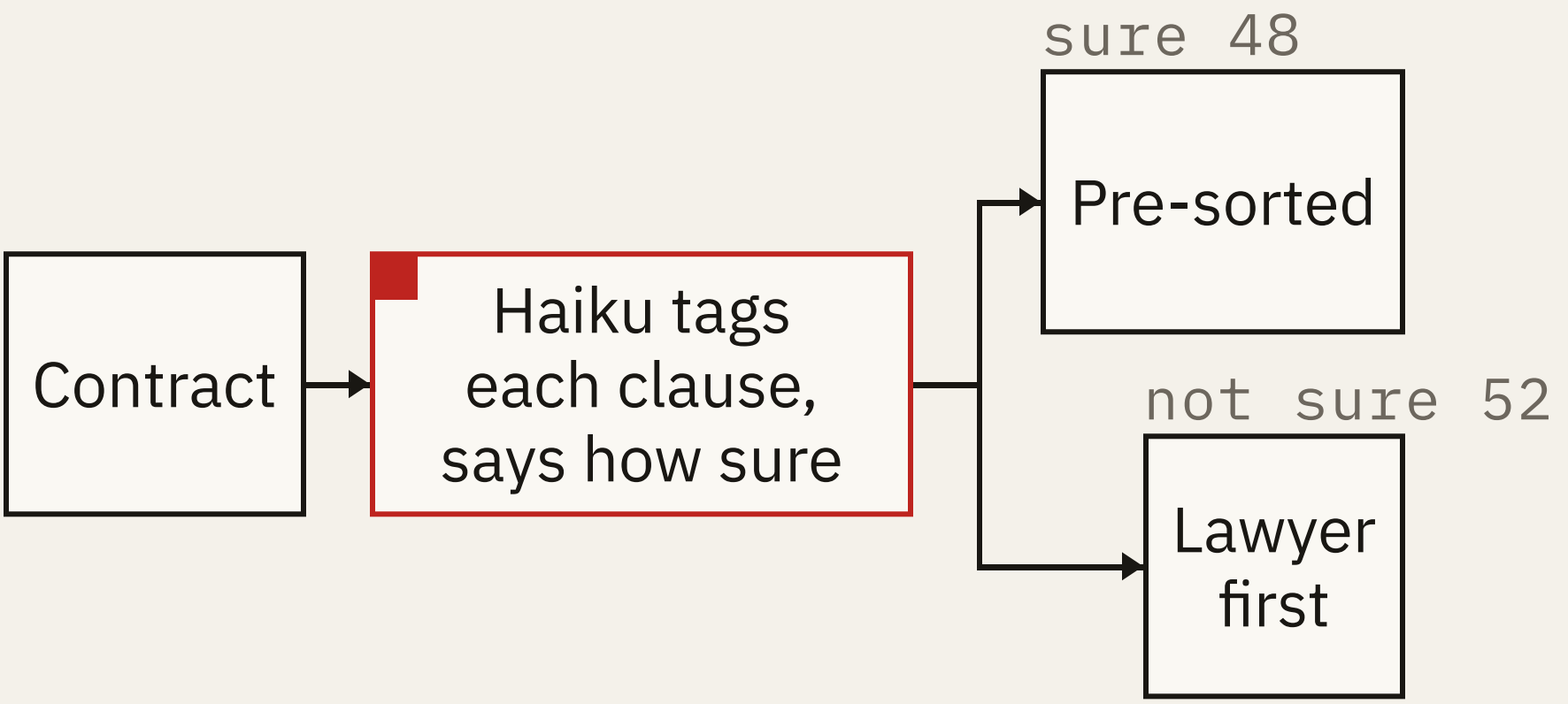
One point less, 29 cents on the dollar.

Statute-to-facts and advice-or-information checks. Opus 5.5 alone: 96 of 100 at $5.24 per 1,000.

Haiku and Gemma both read; Opus 5.5 decides the 18 in 100 they split on: 95 of 100 at $1.51 per 1,000.

LEGAL CONSULTING · 876 CASES

Pre-sorting the clause queue



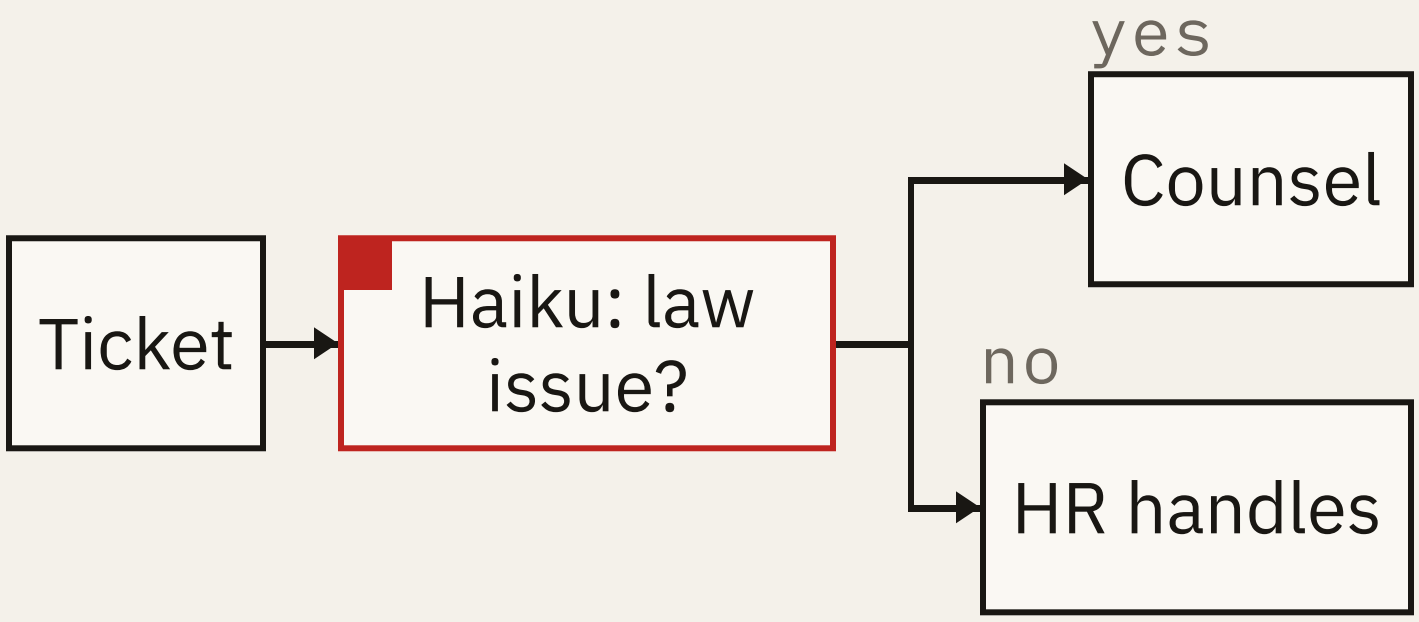
Half pre-sorted, 93 of 100 right.

Three clause types, hearsay, jurisdiction, contracts, advice check. Opus 5.5 scores 85 of 100 here.

Advice labels are ambiguous: the labellers agreed 86 of 100 times. The cheap model flags; it does not decide.

HR CONSULTING · 100 TICKETS

Triage on every helpdesk ticket



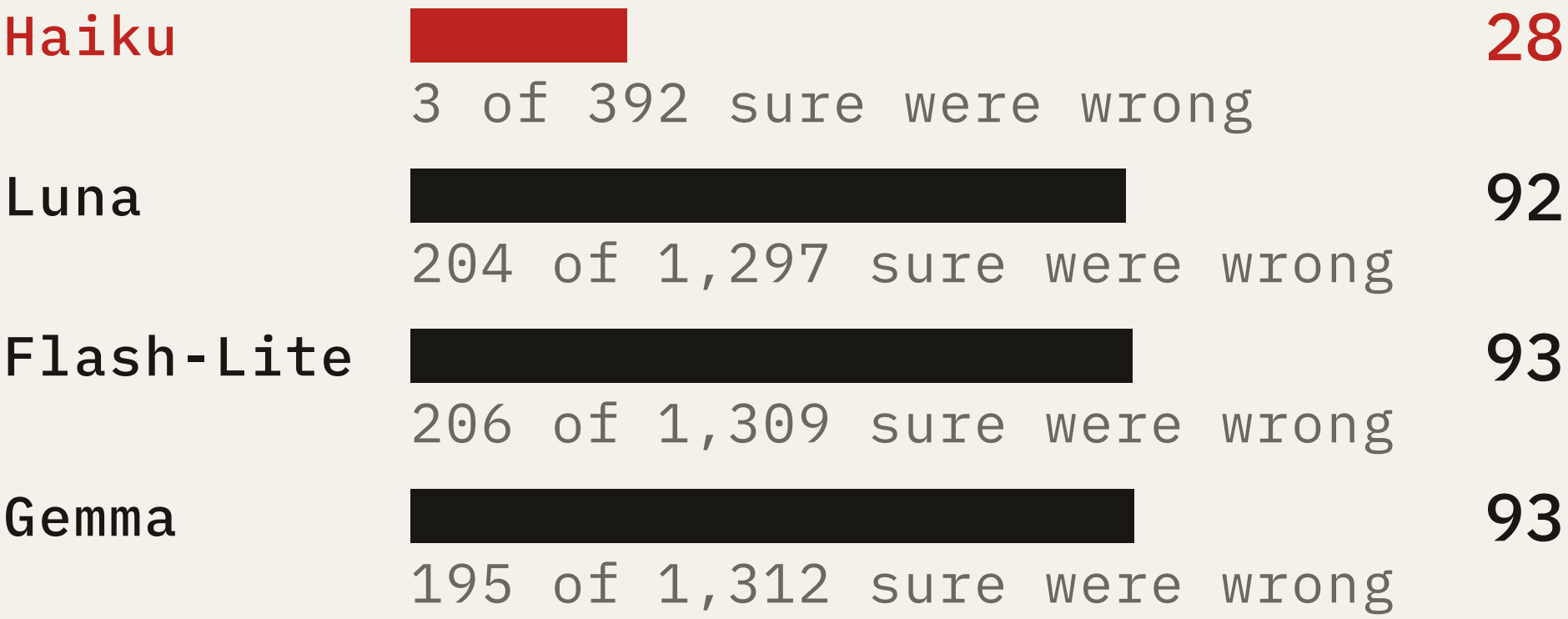
Same as Opus at 3 cents on the dollar.

100 employee questions, expert-labelled. Haiku 96 of 100 at $0.07 per 1,000; Opus 5.5 96 of 100 at $2.63.

Issue-spotting only: the model decides who answers, it does not answer the ticket.

WHY ONE OF THEM CAN SIT AT THE GATE

What sure means, model by model



Sure on 28 of 100, right 99 of 100.

The other three say sure on 92 of 100 answers and are wrong on about 1 in 6 of those.

1,414 cases, one prompt, confidence stated by the model itself. Majority vote does not fix it.

WHAT TO DO ON MONDAY

Four rules for the cheap tier

1 Haiku at the gate; threshold set per task.

2 Behind it, Opus 5.5 or a person, not another cheap model.

3 In tax, a free local model as the second reader.

4 Measure sure but wrong on your own sample first.

The whole test cost $7.27.

Code, prompts and scored summaries are public; the link is in the first comment.

Five models, 10 tasks, one prompt. A routing decision, not a leaderboard.